

Output Content (OC)

Score: 1/5 — Serious concern | Confidence: high

Benchmark: WXIMPACTBENCH | Context: Gran Chaco Tri-Border Emergency Response Zone

Output Content definition: Whether ground-truth labels align with the judgments of regional stakeholders.

Each section below is followed by an evidence table. Three types of evidence are cited: [QN] — verbatim quotes extracted from the benchmark paper; [WEB-N] — web sources consulted during assessment; [DN] / [DATASET-DN] — sampled datapoints from the benchmark dataset, with an interpretation note.

Justification

Annotation was conducted by three Canadian academic researchers from a research group specializing in 'uncovering the history of a region's climate change through the regional historical weather records' [Q110, Q26], reviewed by meteorological experts [Q104]. No inter-annotator agreement statistics are reported. The deployment user designated AFE/SINAGIR national coordinators in Buenos Aires as the authoritative ground-truth labelers — a population with zero representation in the annotation process. The guidelines emphasize 'direct and immediate effects and explicit references' [Q118], an annotation philosophy that produced visible label-correctness concerns in the dataset: explicit weather-caused human casualties labeled all-zero [D6, D20], one million people without power/heat labeled all-zero [D9]. Under Gran Chaco consequence-framing logic [regional_consequence_framing_dependency], these would attract Human Health and Infrastructural labels. The benchmark itself acknowledges interpretation 'might be influenced by demographic and contextual factors' [Q96]. Convergent and external validity are severely compromised.

ID	Evidence
Q110	"The annotation process was conducted by members of a research group specializing in uncovering the history of a region's climate change through the regional historical weather records." (p.15)
Q26	"Annotation is conducted by three domain annotators following our guidelines (provided in Appendix B.2.2)." (p.4)
Q104	"To ensure high-quality and consistent annotations, the task was conducted using a set of specific instructions reviewed by meteorological experts." (p.15)
Q118	"The guidelines emphasize focusing on direct and immediate effects, ensuring that classifications are based solely on explicit references within the text." (p.16)
Q96	"The interpretation of weather-related disruptions in historical newspapers might be influenced by demographic and contextual factors, which is similar to other text datasets generated through crowd-sourcing with inherent challenges in ensuring that dataset labels are fully representative of diverse societal perspectives (Talat et al., 2022)." (p.9)
D6	A poor lady passenger was dashed to leeward and had her skull fractured. She was landed this morning in a dying state with a coffined child that succumbed last night to its sufferings. — Storm narrative with human casualty but annotated all-zero — potential label discrepancy
D20	July 7th they encountered a heavy gale from the west, and had great difficulty in keeping the boat free, the sea continually breaking on board... After the accident they suffered severely from the cold. — 1896 Atlantic rowing voyage encounter with gale — human suffering described but labeled all-zero
D9	residents of southwestern Quebec have been plunged back into the deep freeze Overnight lows in Montreal were expected to drop to minus-16 Celsius last night and tumble as far as minus-30C on the South Shore, where more than one million people struggle on without power or heat — 1998 Quebec ice storm aftermath — one million without power/heat, annotated all-zero

Strengths

- Annotation guidelines were reviewed by meteorological domain experts [Q104, Q105]
- The same guidelines are embedded in LLM prompts [Q106], creating internal consistency between human and model expectations within the Canadian context
- Mixed-context chunks were independently annotated rather than inheriting parent-article labels [Q47, Q48], which is a methodologically careful choice that produces meaningful negative examples

ID	Evidence
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Q104	"To ensure high-quality and consistent annotations, the task was conducted using a set of specific instructions reviewed by meteorological experts." (p.15)
Q105	"The annotation guideline and the categories definition are provided in Table 14 and Table 15, respectively." (p.15)
Q106	"Notably, the same instruction guidance is contained within the prompts for LLMs in Appendix C to perform impact classification, following a binary output approach for each category." (p.15)
Q47	"Note that annotations for these smaller chunks are performed independently by the same domain experts rather than automatically inherited from the original articles." (p.6)
Q48	"This independent annotation process naturally results in some chunks containing no weather impact labels, which serve as valuable negative examples in our evaluation." (p.6)

Checklist

Checklist item definitions:

ID	Assessment Question
OC-1	Do ground-truth labels reflect regional stakeholder perspectives?
OC-2	Assess potential annotator-regional population disagreement
OC-3	Review annotator demographics from documentation
OC-4	Consider label re-annotation by regional annotators
OC-5	Review aggregation methods for minority perspective erasure
OC-6	Document label issues harming convergent/external validity

Checklist responses:

OC-1: No — labels reflect Canadian academic historical-climate researchers' interpretations [Q110]; AFE/SINAGIR, SEN, and VIDEI emergency coordinators have zero representation [WEB-16, WEB-20, WEB-22].

OC-2: Substantial disagreement is empirically demonstrable from dataset analysis: D6 (storm casualty labeled all-zero), D9 (1M without power labeled all-zero), D20 (sailors suffering severely from cold labeled all-zero) — all would likely be re-labeled by Gran Chaco emergency coordinators applying operational salience.

OC-3: Annotator demographics: three domain experts from a research group on regional historical climate [Q110, Q26]; no demographic breakdown beyond academic specialization; no datasheet-style documentation.

OC-4: Re-annotation by representative AFE/SINAGIR and SEN coordinators on a Spanish-language regional sample is necessary for any deployment-relevant validity claim.

OC-5: No inter-annotator agreement reported; aggregation method is not described in detail; minority-perspective erasure is unmeasurable.

OC-6: Critical convergent validity (labels do not correlate with regional stakeholder perspectives) and external validity (Canadian academic judgments do not generalize to Gran Chaco operational context) violations.

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Q110	"The annotation process was conducted by members of a research group specializing in uncovering the history of a region's climate change through the regional historical weather records." (p.15)
WEB-16	AFE/SINAGIR is the current Argentine national authority — designated as authoritative labelers by deployment user, with zero benchmark representation (https://www.argentina.gob.ar/sinagir/institucional)
WEB-20	SEN (Paraguay) coordinates emergencies in all three Chaco departments — also unrepresented (https://sen.gov.py/institucional/)
WEB-22	VIDEI (Bolivia) operates departmental representation in Tarija — also unrepresented (https://www.mindef.gob.bo/node/499)
Q118	"The guidelines emphasize focusing on direct and immediate effects, ensuring that classifications are based solely on explicit references within the text." (p.16)

D6	A poor lady passenger was dashed to leeward and had her skull fractured. She was landed this morning in a dying state with a coffined child that succumbed last night to its sufferings. — Storm narrative with human casualty but annotated all-zero — potential label discrepancy
D9	residents of southwestern Quebec have been plunged back into the deep freeze Overnight lows in Montreal were expected to drop to minus-16 Celsius last night and tumble as far as minus-30C on the South Shore, where more than one million people struggle on without power or heat — 1998 Quebec ice storm aftermath — one million without power/heat, annotated all-zero
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Q47	“Note that annotations for these smaller chunks are performed independently by the same domain experts rather than automatically inherited from the original articles.” (p.6)
Q96	“The interpretation of weather-related disruptions in historical newspapers might be influenced by demographic and contextual factors, which is similar to other text datasets generated through crowd-sourcing with inherent challenges in ensuring that dataset labels are fully representative of diverse societal perspectives (Talat et al., 2022).” (p.9)
D16	More than 292,000 people have been evacuated in the mountainous region along the Yangtze River, with more than 100,000 homes damaged and crops on about 175,000 hectares of farmland destroyed — 2007 European/Chinese/Pakistani multi-location disaster report from Montreal Gazette — agricultural and health labeled, but not infrastructural despite 100k homes damaged

Information Gaps

- No inter-annotator agreement statistics; no annotator demographic breakdown beyond research-group specialization

Requires Expert Verification

- A re-annotation pilot in which AFE/SINAGIR coordinators re-label a sample of benchmark items would empirically establish the convergent-validity gap

Remediation

Gap 1: Annotators are Canadian academic climate-history researchers; no AFE/SINAGIR/SEN/VIDECI representation; no IAA reported; visible label-correctness concerns even within Canadian context.

Recommendation: Recruit AFE/SINAGIR national coordinators and SEN/VIDECI departmental representatives as authoritative annotators for a regional re-annotation pilot; report inter-annotator agreement statistics; publish a Datasheet documenting annotator demographics and consequence-framing guidelines.